Story Comparison Multi-Step Project - PHASE 4

On a trip to the beach, a young boy unintentionally digs a hole to China. When he arrives at China, via the hole, China is furious. They capture him and start World War III in response to his crime.

Setting: The story is set in a small town near a beach.

Characters:

1.

Full Name: Johnathan Doe

Character Portrait: Johnathan Doe is a small, skinny boy with brown hair.

2.

Full Name: Li Wei

Character Portrait: Li Wei is a small Chinese man with black hair.

Phase 4

The further expansion of the outline generated from your story premise has been recopied below for your convenience. Once again, you can fix errors, edit the plot, etc; make as many or as few changes as you'd like, though try not to change the overall lengths too much. Please only make changes to the newly added parts of the outline.

Remember that the time limit for Part 3 is 5 minutes.

Setting: The story is set in a small town near a beach.

Characters:

1.

Full Name: Johnathan Doe

Character Portrait: Johnathan Doe is a small, plump boy with brown hair.

2.

Full Name: Li Wei

Character Portrait: Li Wei is a small old Chinese man with grey hair.

3. Johnathan and Li Wei realize everything was a misunderstanding and they try to stop the war. Scene: a small town near a beach. Characters: Johnathan Doe, Li Wei

a. The war devastates the planet, Johnathan and Li Wei must convince all world leaders to make peace with a heartfelt speech. Scene: various locations around the world. Characters: Johnathan Doe, Li Wei

i. The war devastates the planet, millions die. Scene: various locations around the world. Characters: Johnathan Doe, Li Wei

ii. Johnathan and Li Wei manage to get in contact with all world leaders and convince them to make peace with a heartfelt speech. Scene: various locations around the world. Characters: Johnathan Doe, Li Wei, Vladamir Puttin, Barack Obama

b. Johnathan and Li Wei make peace with each other and Johnathan returns from whence he came. Scene: a small town near a beach. Characters: Li Wei, Johnathan Doe

i. The war ends and Johnathan and Li Wei make peace with each other. Scene: a small town near a beach. Characters: Johnathan Doe, Li Wei

ii. Johnathan returns to his home and Li Wei returns to China. Scene: a small town near a beach and in China. Characters: Johnathan Doe, Li Wei

Minimum word count: 0

Optional Comments

Figure 8: Surge AI annotation example for human interactive experiment, Phase 4. Plans are abridged. The output of Phase 4 is the final plan used for DOC (System B).

Story Comparison Multi-Step Project - PHASE 5

As a reminder, in Phase 1, you provided the following premise:

A mother is left at a crossroads as her child moves out and she is left to redefine who she is as a person. As she is cleaning her child's old room she comes across a box of old notes she had written to her over the years and soon discovers who she is is who she has been all along.

In Phases 2–4, you built out the following story plans:

System A:	System B:
Setting: The story is set in a mother's house as she is going through her child's old room after they have moved out. Characters: 1. Full Name: Nadine Darling Character Portrait: Nadine Darling is a middle-aged woman with shoulder-length brown hair that is starting to gray at the temples. 2. Full Name: Anna Darling Character Portrait: Anna Darling is Nadine's daughter who is in her late teens.	Setting: The story is set in a mother's house as she is going through her child's old room after they have moved out. Characters: 1. Full Name: Nadine Darling Character Portrait: Nadine Darling is a middle-aged woman with shoulder-length brown hair that is starting to gray at the temples. 2. Full Name: Anna Darling Character Portrait: Anna Darling is Nadine's daughter who is in her late teens.

Below, we show the two final generated stories side-by-side, with passages aligned based on the top-level outline items. (As the stories are quite lengthy, it is perfectly fine to just very quickly scan through them. No need to spend more than a couple minutes per story passage.) Please answer the question following each passage.

(FYI, some people mentioned that they wanted to make further changes, but didn't want to change too much due to the instructions. We apologize for the unclear instructions on what you were allowed to change; we actually intended for you to be able to change/fix a lot more. For this experiment we just went with what you actually submitted, and treated that as what you intended. In any case, the questions mainly focus on just the top-level outline and overall process, and neither system will be perfect anyway.)

System A, Passage 1:	System B, Passage 1:
Nadine discovers a box of old notes she wrote to her children over the years while cleaning her child's old room.	Nadine discovers a box of old notes she wrote to Anna over the years while cleaning her daughter's old room.
Nadine Darling sat in the large brown leather chair with her head in her hands. She was thinking about what she had done to her daughter and how she would ever be forgiven. She had been sitting there for nearly an hour and was now starting to feel tired, but could not bare the thought of bed just yet. It was too early for bed and she didn't want to think about what a miserable mess she had made of her life. She was exhausted, but couldn't sleep. This was not a new experience for her as she had felt like this on many occasions in the past and the only thing that worked was to let her mind go and let her thoughts flow through her. She had decided long ago that if she tried to force herself to think of something else, she would only end up feeling more stuck and mired in negative thoughts.	Nadine Darling stands in her daughter, Anna's, room. She looks around the room, which is mostly empty. All that remains are a few boxes stacked in one corner and Anna's dresser, which is full of clothes and jewelry and other things Anna will not need for a while. Nadine pulls open the boxes to see what's inside them. She finds some papers, a few empty books she remembers buying for her children to read, and a lot of junk. She tosses everything into the box and closes it up tight, then sets it on top of the dresser. She cleans off the dresser and packs away all the things there. Nadine looks at a stack of papers lying on her old desk: an old newspaper clipping, a letter from Anna's teacher, and some notes she made while reading to her children over the years. These are worth keeping, Nad ine thinks. They capture the years of Anna's childhood. Nadine puts them in her purse and closes up her daughters desk for good.

Which of the two passages above (Passage 1) stayed closest to your original intentions as the author?

- ○ Passage from System A
- ○ Passage from System B
- ○ No Preference (difference is very small; it is hard to choose between them)

Finally, we'd like for you to answer some high-level questions.

1. Overall, which system's workflow gave you more control?

- ○ System A
- ○ System B
- ○ No Preference (difference is very small; it is hard to choose between them)

2. Which system did you feel was more helpful/intuitive to work with?

- ○ System A
- ○ System B
- ○ No Preference (difference is very small; it is hard to choose between them)

3. In a context where quality is important (e.g., for a publication), which system would you choose if you were to write another story?

- ○ System A
- ○ System B
- ○ No Preference (difference is very small; it is hard to choose between them)

Do you have any other comments that you'd like to share with us? (Optional)

Figure 9: Surge AI annotation example for human interactive experiment, Phase 5. Plans and story passages are abridged. The question about original intentions as author (Intent metric) is asked once for each pair of top-level outline items and corresponding passages, although only one instance is shown here. The remaining questions are asked only once at the bottom.

We're a group of NLP/AI researchers working on story generation. Below are short descriptions of events, each followed by a story passage. For each pair, please skim and then mark whether the given event unambiguously occurs in its entirety within the passage.
Note that many passages will be highly relevant to the event, but will not actually contain the event, and you should answer "No" for these. Please quickly skim the examples below before doing this task for the first time.
We expect each example to take a minute or so; it's fine to just very quickly scan rather than reading carefully. (Passages are roughly 500 words on average, though some may be significantly shorter/longer. Just use your best judgment if you're unsure on legitimately hard/ambiguous examples. No need to spend too much time on any one example.)

Example 1:
Event Description: The townspeople locking their doors at night.
Passage: The townspeople thought about calling the police, but, ifthey did, they feared the killer would come after them. The police weren't like real police officers. They couldn't keep the townspeople safe. Thetownspeople were afraid that the police wouldn't be able to catch the killer.

The only thing they hadn't done was lock their doors. It's not like they could hide their doors. They had no locks to close. The only thing they could do was close their windows and lock the shades.The townspeople were hoping that this would be the last night they had to worry. They wanted to sleep peacefully with no worries.

Response: No. (it's kind of on topic, but they explicitly don't lock their doors).

Example 2:
Event Description: Karen Miller explains to the hitman what she wants him to do.
Passage: Karen walked briskly down the sidewalk toward the coffee shop.She knew that it was better if she arrived first and had a moment to herself so that she could think about what exactly she wanted to say. She was nervousand her hands were shaking, so she tried to focus on the information that the hitman had sent to her. She knew that she wanted to talk about howmuch her husband was worth and that she wanted the hitman to come up with a plan for the best way to kill Bill. She was not sure if shewas ready to just go through with it and get it over with.

Karen arrived at the coffee shop a few minutes before the hitman did,and she was very glad for it. She was not sure of the best way to broach the subject of what exactly the hitman was going to do andhow he would do it, but she tried to focus on what she wanted. She was not sure how she felt about the fact that the hitman was soexperienced in this type of job, but she was not totally opposed to it. She knew that he was the best man for the job.
Response: No. (it looks like she might explain to him soon, but this clearly hasn't happened yet and it's not totally clear that it will. **But you should mark yes if the passage clearly states the event did occur at any point in time, even if e.g., it's in the past**).

Example 3:
Event Description: Karen is shocked and doesn't believe the hitman at first.
Passage: Then Karen's husband had been shot twenty times and he was dead. The police went to see the hitman and they asked him why he had doneit and the hitman said that he had done it because Karen had told him to and then the police said that they would arrest Karen first and then the hitman. But the police did not arrest Karen and she was dead so that did not matter. The hitman went home and he smoked a cigarette and then hecalled his wife.

Karen was shocked. She could not believe it. She had just died. Then the hitman told Karen that she was goingto die too and then he shot Karen. Then the hitman said that Karen smelled like fish and then he killed his wife.
Response: Yes. (The passage is kind of nonsensical at times, but it unambiguously contains Karen being shocked and being in disbelief.)

Example 4:
Event Description: Sarah starts to miss Ryan.
Passage: "I'm hitting that double digit mark," she said. "getting up there in years, you know."
Jenna laughed. "You're kidding," she said.
Sarah smiled back at her and shook her head. "No, I'm not," she said.
Jenna stopped walking and turned toward Sarah, not breaking eye contact. "Which means what?" she said.
"Which means that I'm starting to miss him," Sarah said. "I'm starting to miss the things he used to do for me."
Jenna looked away and down at the sidewalk. "It's okay to miss him," she said. She looked up and met Sarah's gaze again. "But you can't go back."
Sarah nodded. "I know," she said. "And I don't want to go back, but I don't have anyone else."
Jenna looked at her.
"What do you mean?" she said.
"I mean, I don't have anyone else," Sarah said.
Response: Yes. (Ryan isn't explicitly named, but it's fine to assume they are talking about Ryan here. In general, feel free to assume things that seem to be clearly implied by what does occur in the passage.)
Collapse Instructions

Event Description: Aimee and Kyle say goodbye.
Passage:
"My mom and dad loved me very much, they just didn't understand me. They thought I was hiding some secret from them, but really I just needed to be around other kids my age who would understand me."
"Did you have any friends when you were growing up?"
"I did. I had a best friend named Brianne, we grew up together and we had the best times together. Her parents were really rich so she had everything that I wanted but my parents didn't have the money to give me, and her family always took me places."
"I bet she was popular in school," he said.
"I don't think she went to school very much. She lived on the other side of town in a big house with lots of rooms that were full of furniture." She smiled. "She was a really sweet person and she never made me feel like I didn't have anything just because my family wasn't as rich as hers. We shared clothes and stuff like that. It was great, we were best friends for years until my parents had to move out of state and we lost touch. I tried finding her but she was nowhere to be found."
"I'm sure she knows you thought the world of her, wherever she is."
"I hope so. That would make me feel better if I knew she knew that."
"It seems that you have very fond memories of her," he said.
"Yeah, I do. We had a lot of fun together when we were kids. At the end of the day I would come home to an empty house and Brianne would be there with cookies, or whatever. When I was upset about something she would give me a hug and tell me everything was going to be alright. I wish I had told her how much she meant to me back then, but I was too scared of being rejected. I didn't want to make her feel bad about herself."
"That seems like a very sweet thing for a child to do."
"I guess it was."
She took a deep breath and felt her eyes start to well up with tears. She cleared her throat and looked at Kyle.
"I'm sorry, I didn't mean to get so emotional," she said.
"It's alright, you're allowed to show your true emotions around me. I won't judge you for that."
Aimee smiled and wiped the tears from her eyes.
"Thank you for saying that."
"Do you think that it has made it more difficult for you to foster friendships with adults?" he asked.
"I don't think so," she replied. "I just told you about my fears and I have no problem showing my emotions around you. I think I am more comfortable around younger people, not older ones."
Kyle nodded and then said, "Do you think it is because they see you for who you really are?"
"Yes, I do. I think it is easier for them to be honest with me because they don't know me in the same way adults do. They have nothing to lose, and they are more likely to tell me what I want to hear."
Aimee felt her eyes glistening again and looked away from Kyle for a moment. He was looking at her with concern on his face and she felt ashamed of crying after just getting out of the shower. She decided to change the subject and asked him, "What about you? How many friends do you have?"
Kyle paused for a moment before replying, "Not very many. I had a group of friends in my twenties, but we have all gone our separate ways now. Some got married, some moved away and some started families. I'm not even sure if they would consider me their friend anymore or if we just remain close acquaintances."
"I'm sure they think of you as a friend," said Aimee. "Probably more of a friend than you actually are to them."
"Thank you for the kind words," said Kyle with a smile. He continued, "They seem to be doing fine without me. I guess my life doesn't have the same appeal now that I'm getting older and less exciting."
"So what are you doing with your life?" asked Aimee. "I mean, besides working and reading books? Are you seeing anyone? Do you have a girlfriend or are you single?"
Kyle's face took on a playful expression as he said, "I guess I don't have much of a life, but I don't think it bothers me as much as it used to. I don't date much anymore and even if I did, it wouldn't amount to anything. As for my social life, I usually speak more with my co-workers than I do with my friends or family. It's just easier that way. It doesn't hurt when they live in the same town as you."
Aimee looked at Kyle and noticed a look of sadness in his eyes. She asked, "Do you think I'm a total loser for being this sad and lonely?"
"No," Kyle said softly. He thought about what he wanted to say before continuing. "I think it's perfectly normal to feel sad and alone sometimes, especially if you're young. Life is hard sometimes, but that doesn't mean there isn't anything worth looking forward to. You just have to keep your eye out for it. Sometimes, the things we want most in life are the things that we can't see from where we're standing."
Aimee nodded in understanding. She suddenly felt less alone and more hopeful. "Thank you, Kyle," she said.

Does the given event occur in its entirety within the passage?

○ Yes ?

○ No ?

Figure 10: Surge AI annotation example for detailed relevance from our experiments in Table 6.